





"How can a bar call itself seasonal and still serve mango in winter? At Sidecar, each month brings a new highlight—from bael and ber to mulberry."

MINAKSHI SINGH
CEO & Co-founder, Sidecar

Leading mixologists foraging for ingredients at Spirit of the Ubud Jungle festival at Mandapa Reserve (Top centre); An Kyoungwon, co-founder, M+MS, Seoul; Minakshi Singh, CEO and co-owner of Sidecar (Above)

"Bartending is reconnecting with its roots," says Adi San, who leads the bar programme at Ambar. His approach is built on working closely with local farmers and communities, often incorporating rare, hyperlocal ingredients into familiar formats. "It's not just about flavour," he explains and adds, "It's about linking the drink to its origin, the land and the people behind it."

His cocktail My Grandma captures this philosophy succinctly. Inspired by the Balinese tradition of chewing betel leaf, it layers turmeric, wild honey, and a house-made liqueur into a concoction that feels classic yet deeply personal. It's less a drink, more a distillation of memory in a glass.

This shift—from product to provenance—is being seen across top bars, with each geography implementing as per their local availability. At FURA in Singapore, sustainability isn't framed as a buzzword but as responsibility. "There's no single rule to define it," says Christina Rasmussen, co-owner and head chef. "For us, it's about future foods, circularity, and understanding the impact we can have when we serve hundreds of guests every week," she says

Operating in a city where only about one per cent of land is allocated to agriculture, FURA looks beyond the idea of 'local' in a traditional sense. Ingredients are chosen based on abundance, regional relevance, and carbon footprint. Hydroponic greens from Singapore sit alongside produce sourced from the Cameron Highlands in Malaysia that are grown using regenerative and pesticide-free methods.

The drinks themselves push boundaries. Caviar Papi reimagines indul-